search the South for the kidnapped Sita, which means crossing all the major rivers until they arrive at the southern sea:

> *‘Go forth,’ he cried, ‘with all this host*
> *Exploring to the southern coast:*
> *The thousand peaks that Vindhya shows*
> *Where every tree and creeper grows:*
> *Where Narmada’s sweet waters run,*
> *And serpents bask them in the sun:*
> *Where Krishnaveni’s currents flee,*
> *And sparkles fair Godavari …*
> *Search well his forests where the breeze*
> *Blows fragrant from the sandal trees.*
> *Then will you see Kaveri’s stream*
> *Whose pleasant waters glance and gleam,*
> *And to the lovely banks entice*
> *The sportive maids of Paradise.*
> *High on the top of Malaya’s hill,*
> *In holy musing, calm and still,*
> *Sits, radiant as the Lord of Light,*
> *Agastya, noblest anchorite.*
> *Soon as that lofty-thoughted lord*
> *His high permission shall accord,*
> *Pass Tamrapaní’s flood whose isles*
> *Are loved by basking crocodiles.*
> *The sandal woods that fringe her side*
> *Those islets and her waters hide;*
> *While, like an amorous matron, she*
> *Speeds to her own dear lord the sea.*
> *Thence hasting on your way behold*
> *The Pandyas’ gates of pearl and gold.*
> *Then, with your task maturely planned,*
> *On ocean’s shore your feet will stand.*
> *Where, by Agastya’s high decree,*
> *Mahendra, planted in the sea,*[8]